

U.S. History





About the Course

Read United States and world history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grade 4 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	U.S. History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans Children of the Wild West Lincoln: A Photobiography SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

□ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6



Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans



Children of the Wild West



Lincoln: A Photobiography



SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



U.S. History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a

student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

A Duck, A Dog, and a Deal

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ PREP

1. Please note that a few of the chapters will be skipped for the sake of time. You can encourage your student to read those chapters outside of lesson time.
2. You may want to read the introduction to get some more background knowledge about the book.

→ INTRO

This year, we are studying the history of the United States from 1800-1900. President Thomas Jefferson acquired a large amount of land west of the Mississippi for \$15 million through the Louisiana Purchase from France. He chose Meriwether Lewis to head an expedition to explore this area. Along with William Clark and a select group of men, a dog named Seaman joined the expedition. We learn about this dog in the journals of Lewis and Clark. For a long time, people thought the name of the dog was Scannon because it was hard to read the handwriting. Over the years more information about Seaman has been found in the journals and other sources. That is what makes the study of history interesting—historians continue to find more evidence that adds to a fuller understanding of the past. The author wrote this story based on Lewis and Clark's journals that were originally written with a quill pen!

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

At the beginning of the this book, Lewis is in Pittsburgh and then needs to meet Clark before heading to Camp Wood where they will spend the winter before they begin their expedition. Trace this route on the map. What rivers will he be traveling along to get to the camp? (Ohio and Mississippi)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-beginning of Ch.2 p.1-11 "The huge black"- "lift their spirits."

- One of the goals of the expedition was to look for the Northwest Passage. Many thought there would be a direct water route across the continent that led to the Pacific Ocean. It was believed that this waterway could open a direct trade route between North America and Asia. Lewis and Clark were to find out and let President Jefferson know. Do you know if there is a direct water route from the Atlantic to the Pacific? You can look at a map to find out.

→ VIEW

Look at the entry from Lewis' journal on p.9. What do you notice about the spelling? Spelling changes over time. You will notice different spellings in the other entries as well.

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have time, this is an interesting video that talks about the Louisiana Purchase and the reasons for the expedition.

∞ **Video Link:** Lewis and Clark Expedition Part 1

WEEK 2

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Getting Ready

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

You have met Meriwether Lewis, who was President Jefferson's personal secretary and an officer in the United States Army. Now we will meet William Clark who was a retired officer who had served alongside Lewis in the Army. He will be the expedition's co-leader. Here is a replica of the keelboat that was built for this expedition. It was 55 feet long (almost the length of a bowling alley) with room for about 20 men to row and more space for supplies.

∞ Image Link: Replica of keelboat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.2 p.11-18 "Along the banks"- "of a dog."

- Why might a dog be a good companion for the expedition?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis and Clark

This statue on the Ohio River in Clarksville, Indiana, marks the meeting place where the two explorers met.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1804 Lewis and Clark Expedition begins

WEEK 3

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

The Journey Begins

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Today you will read about the men who were chosen to be in the Corps (pronounced /kor/) of

Term 1

Discovery. What kind of skills do you think would helpful for these men to have?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.2-3 p.18-27 "On November 20-a beautiful place."

→ VIEW

One of the goals of the expedition was to learn about plant and animal species and bring back samples. Here is a journal page that shows a drawing of a pheasant.

∞ Image Link: Journal Entry from Clark

WEEK 4

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

Sioux Territory

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping ch.4 for the sake of time. There will be a brief summary of it in the introduction.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping ch. 4 but one important incident to note is that Sergeant Charles Floyd developed serious stomach pains. Lewis gave him different medications that he had brought with. However, Floyd died at the age of 22. They held a funeral service for him on a hill overlooking a river and named it "Sergeant Floyds Bluff." Many people now think he had appendicitis.

2. Trace the route down the Missouri river to the place where Sergeant Floyd died.

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

3. Another goal of the expedition was to establish relations with Native Americans. In today's reading Lewis and Clark will meet the Sioux who live in what is now South Dakota. This is what President Jefferson said to the explorers about the Sioux, "On that nation, we wish more particularly to make a friendly impression, because of their immense power, and because we learn they are very desirous of being on the most friendly terms with us." Let's see if they want to be on friendly terms with the Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.37-45 "On the twenty-seventh" - "Clark climbed aboard."

→ VIEW

Look at the journal entry on p.46. How did Clark show leadership in that situation?

WEEK 5

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Sioux Territory; Winter Among the Indians

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off last time?

→ INTRO

The Corps of Discovery will be meeting another tribe today known as the Arikaras. Look at the map to see their location. What state did they live in?

∞ Image Link: Expedition Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.47-56 "As evening approached" - "understand each other."

→ VIEW

This is a picture of a reconstructed earth lodge that the Arikaras would have lived in.

∞ Image Link: Earth Lodge

WEEK 6

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

Winter Among the Indians

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading you will meet a teenage girl who joined the expedition. She has become quite famous in history and there are 16 statues in her honor around the U.S. You will have to keep reading to see how she helps the Corps of Discovery.

∞ Image Link: Sakakawea (another spelling of Sacagawea) Statue in US Capitol

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.6 p.56-66 "The Corps began" - "of my life."

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW

The Corps built Fort Mandan to stay in during the winter of 1804-1805
∞ Image Link: Reconstructed Fort Mandan

WEEK 7

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Perils in Paradise

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: Today's reading is a little longer. If a teacher reads it aloud, it should take around 18 minutes.

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read last time.

→ INTRO

If you were exploring the wilderness of North Dakota, what animals might you be afraid of? We will read about some animals that brought peril or danger to the Corps of Discovery.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p. 67-77 (whole chapter)

→ VIEW

Read the journal excerpt on p.75. Seaman is mentioned in the Lewis' journal!

DEFINITION

artery (p.74)-any of the vessels that carry blood from the heart through the body

WEEK 8

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

Searching for the Shoshone

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping ch. 8 for the sake of time. Feel free to have your student read it on their own.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping ch.8. In that chapter Seaman is back to normal and chased a 2000 pound buffalo through the campsite. The Corps of Discovery come to a fork in the Missouri river and needed to decide which way to go. They decided to take the southern river and came across many waterfalls that Lewis described as "the grandest sight I ever beheld." The water was falling over a cliff more than 80 feet high. They would have to portage (carry their boats overland) around the waterfalls. To lighten their load they stored some of their supplies in a cache or hiding place in the ground that would get on their way back.

2. Find the Great Falls on the map. Now go along the route until you get to Shoshone. The Corps of Discovery needed to find these people because they had something very valuable the explorers needed.

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 89-97 "Seaman splashed into" - "horses to trade!"

WEEK 9

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

Searching or the Shoshone; Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping ch. 8 for the sake of time. Feel free to have your student read it on their own.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

The reading will be broken up into two sections because we are skipping ch.10. Do you remember what tribe Sacagawea is from? (Shoshone) When she was about 12 years old she was captured by an enemy tribe, the Hidatsa, and later given to the French-Canadian trader, Charbonneau, who was living among the Hidatsa, as one of his wives. It had been about 5 years since she had seen her people.

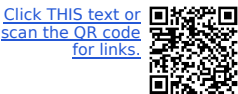
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.9 p.97-101- "The Indians crowded" - "the other explorers."

2. Chapter 10 talked about a very trying time for everyone as they entered the Rocky Mountains. The path was steep, there was little food and it was cold and wet. After hiking more than 150 miles in eleven days they made it over the Rocky Mountains. The men finally got some food from the Nez Perce Indians but after not eating much for 11 days and then gorging on dried fish and berries, the men felt sick.

3. Ch. 11 p. 115-119 "I don't know" - "eating dog meat."

U.S. History: Grades 4-6



Term 1	
→ VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10 <i>Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!</i> 📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark → RECAP → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.11 p.119-128 "By the time" - "O! the joy." → VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11 <i>A Soggy Winter</i> 📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark → RECAP What happened last time? → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.12 p.129-137 "The next day" - "but known distance." Note: The rest of the chapter will not be assigned. You may want students to read it during exam week. → VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Seaman: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark	

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Blackfeet and Bad Luck

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping ch.13 for the sake of time. Students can always read it outside of lesson time.

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off ?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14 p.159-167 "Seaman paced through" - "had led his party."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 2

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.14-15 p.167-179 -"tail wagging eagerly."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 3

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

The Mysterious Mr. Lincoln; A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ INTRO

What do you know about Abraham Lincoln? There are more books written about Lincoln than any other American. This book is called a photobiography. How might photos help us understand a person from the past instead of just words? How might photos not give us a complete picture of the past?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-Beginning of ch.2 p.1-10 "Abraham Lincoln wasn't" - "beneath the roof."

•

Definitions

reticent (p.2)-inclined to be silent or uncommunicative in speech
yarns (p.4)-stories
emancipator (p.5)-someone who frees others from bondage

Important Dates

Abraham Lincoln was born 1809

WEEK 4

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ INTRO

Do you have any ideas of how children on the frontier got their schooling? We will read about the kind of schooling Lincoln had.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue ch.2 p.10-19 "Soon after the" - "were fast friends."

•What do you think about the way Lincoln got his education?

WEEK 5

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

A Backwoods Boy; Law and Politics

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ INTRO

Do you have any ideas of how children on the frontier got their schooling? We will read about the kind of schooling Lincoln had.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2- Begin Ch.3 p.19-28 "Lincoln also found" - "just good friends."

WEEK 6

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.3. p.30-37 "While Lincoln was" - knees beside him."

.

WEEK 7

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.3 and begin ch.4 p.37-48 "Lincoln was at" - "way of life."

WEEK 8

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue ch.4 p. 50-59 "The issue came" - "into the air."

.

WEEK 9

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Emancipation

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.4 and begin ch.5 p.59-68 "The give and take" - "compromise had failed."

.

WEEK 10

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.5 p. 68-79 "He traveled east" - "on Tad's bed."

.

Term 2	
WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23 <i>This Dreadful War</i> Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography PREP: There is one more week of this book in Term 3 which tells about Lincoln's assassination. We are skipping ch.6 which is about the war for the sake of time and due to the graphic details in the chapter. You may want to read parts of it with your student during exam week. Otherwise there will be a couple paragraphs read in L25 before we finish the book. → RECAP What did you read about last time? → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Finish ch.5 80-91 "Lincoln took the" - "for this act."	
WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Lincoln: A Photobiography	

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Who Is Dead in the White House?

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch. 6 p.100-104 "Four months later" - "were black laws."
Ch.7 p.119-130 (whole chapter)

→ **TEACHER NOTE**
Please note the graphic picture on p. 100 of dead soldiers. You may wish to read those few pages aloud.

WEEK 2

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch. 1-2, p.9-21
• Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 3

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.3-4 p.23-37
• Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 4

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.5-6 p.39-51
• Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 5

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

Frontier Photographers; Going West

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ **INTRO**

How do historians write books about the past? They look at primary sources such as letters, documents, and photographs from the time period to try to understand what life was like. In this book, you will be able to see actual photographs from the 1800's to learn about life was like for children who moved with their families to the western part of the United States. If you could ask children from back then any questions about their life, what might you ask them?

→ **LOCATE**

Trace the route of the Oregon Trail. Where does it begin? (Independence, Missouri) In today's reading, you will read about a family that has made it to North Platte River that is now part of current day Wyoming. Find that on the map.
∞ Map Link: Map of Oregon Trail

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.9-18 "On May 19"- "a foreign land."
• Discussion Question Idea

→ **VIEW**

Take time to look at the photographs. What do you think it would be like traveling in the covered wagons?

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 6

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Going West; Settling Down

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-30 "Their journey started" - "by 1855."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 7

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

Settling Down;

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-40 "So far" - "from their own."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

The American Indians

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.40-57

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

Frontier Schools

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-69 "I remember the" - "to be trouble."

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10

25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Building the West

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-81

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

Term 3	
WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35 Games, Parties, and Celebrations Materials: Children of the Wild West → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.83-94 • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Children of the Wild West	